

Gihun Im

Department of Psychological and Quantitative Foundations, University of Iowa
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Student in Counseling Psychology

Aug 2024 – Present

The University of Iowa, Iowa City, IA, United States
Advisor: Amanda S. Case, Ph.D.
GPA: 4.22

M.A. in Educational Counseling

Mar 2022 – Feb 2024

Seoul National University, Seoul, South Korea
Advisor: Dongil Kim, Ph.D.

Thesis: Korean school counselors' counseling competencies and advocacy activities for LGBTQ+ youth: A latent profile analysis
GPA: 4.26

B.A. in English Education & B.A. in Psychology

Mar 2011 – Feb 2018

Chung-Ang University, Seoul, South Korea, *dual degree*
GPA: 4.14, *Magna Cum Laude*

PROFESSIONAL AND CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

Nov 2025 – May 2026

Department of Counselor Education, University of Iowa
Supervisor: Isak Kim, Ph.D.

- Coordinated counseling research projects involving IRB protocol development, Qualtrics survey design, and participant recruitment
- Analyzed large-scale data sets (e.g., Healthy Minds Study) and contributed to manuscript preparation
- Contributed to internal and external grant applications focused on counselor training, digital mental health, and underserved populations

Graduate Research Assistant

Mar 2025 – May 2026

Telepsychology Training Clinic, University of Iowa
Supervisor: Martin Kivlighan, Ph.D.

- Managed administrative tasks related to clinic operations
- Maintained connections with community resources to support rural mental health
- Coordinated workshops and outreach activities

Doctoral Trainee

Aug 2024 – May 2026

University Counseling Service, University of Iowa
Supervisor: Patrick Galligan, Ph.D.

- Provide brief individual therapy for undergraduate and graduate students
- Conduct initial consultation and single-session intervention
- Engage in outreach activities to promote campus mental health awareness
- Facilitate group therapy

Graduate Research Assistant

Aug 2024 – May 2025

Department of Psychological and Quantitative Foundations, University of Iowa
Supervisor: Julie M. Koch, Ph.D.

- Conducted literature reviews and preliminary regression analyses examining LGBTQ+ mental health outcomes within interdisciplinary research collaborations

- Conducted literature reviews and developed practice guideline outlines for therapists working in international and LGBTQ+-neutral contexts
- Supported ongoing research and departmental scholarly initiatives
- Assisted the department coordinator with administrative tasks

Certified School Counselor

Mar 2024 – Aug 2024

Dangsan Middle School, *Full-time*

- Provided individual/group counseling for middle school students (450+ students)
- Delivered social-emotional learning (SEL) and anti-bullying programs

Intern Counselor

Mar 2022 – Feb 2024

SNU Center for Campus Life & Culture, Seoul National University

- Provided counseling and performed psychological assessments for undergraduate and graduate students
- Led and co-led group counseling programs

Research Assistant

Mar 2022 – Feb 2024

Department of Education, Seoul National University

Supervisor: Dongil Kim, Ph.D.

- Conducted quantitative and qualitative research on LGBTQ+ mental health, counselor training, career development, and youth intervention programs
- Utilized diverse methodologies, including structural equation modeling (SEM), factor analysis, latent class and profile analysis (LCA/LPA), mediation/moderation modeling, Delphi methods, focus group interviews (FGIs), thematic analysis, consensual qualitative research (CQR), and program evaluation
- Supported research dissemination through manuscript preparation, conference presentations, literature reviews, survey development, and data analysis

Certified School Counselor

Mar 2019 – Feb 2022

Seoul Metropolitan Office of Education (headquarters), *Full-time*

- Contributed to creating government policies and guidelines for the school counseling system in Seoul
- Developed counseling and guidance programs for 1,300+ school counseling offices (*Wee Class*) and 26 centers (*Wee Center*) in Seoul
- Implemented crisis intervention programs and conducted counseling services for both students and staff members impacted by traumatic events (7 different occasions)
- Provided psychological consulting as a consultant to school staff members and caregivers
- Offered counseling services to students with mental, academic, and/or developmental issues
- Delivered anti-bullying programs as a lecturer for students who have engaged in school violence, as well as their caregivers

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Guest Lecturer

Spring 2026

CSED:6353 Pre-Practicum & Case Management in Counseling

Department of Counselor Education, University of Iowa

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2026

PSQF:7310 Intelligence Assessment

Department of Psychological and Quantitative Foundations, University of Iowa

- Score assignments and provide feedback on intelligence assessment administrations (WAIS-5, WISC-5, WIAT-4, NEPSY-II, D-KEFS, SB-5, BASC-2)

PUBLICATIONS

[KCI] denotes the Korean Citation Index, indicating that the article is in Korean.

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNALS

4. **Im, G.** (2026). Ethical risk prevention in client generative artificial intelligence (genAI) use: Applying the primary risk-management model. *American Psychologist*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1037/amp0001731>
3. Kim, D., **Im, G.**, Chung, G., & Park, J. (2025). Impact of discussion activity in international youth exchange programs on global citizenship: Mediating role of multicultural competence. *Journal of Education & Culture*, 31(1), 597–613. [KCI]
2. Kim, D., Park, J., & **Im, G.** (2025). Research on developing a social enrichment program for young adults with borderline intellectual functioning. *Disability & Employment*, 35(1), 163–186. [KCI]
1. Kim, D., Park, J., Lee, J., Park, I., & **Im, G.** (2023). Exploring subjects of standardized curriculum for youth counselors in South Korea by Delphi method. *Studies on Korean Youth*, 34(4), 141–162. [KCI]

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

5. **Im, G.** (under review). Outing-related threat and depression among sexual minority adults during the COVID-19 pandemic: Internalized homophobia and the dual role of community connectedness.
4. Kim, I., **Im, G.**, Min, Y., & Ding, R. (under review). Ambivalent engagement with generative AI: Greater mental health use and concern among college students with anxiety-depression.
3. Kim, J., Kang, S., **Im, G.**, & Kim, M. (under review). A systematic review and meta-synthesis on LGBTQ+ partner bereavement: Grief trajectories toward an ecological framework.
2. **Im, G.**, Case, A. S., Bae, I., Ji, S., Tang, Y., & Zhang, Y. (under review). User engagement with ChatGPT for mental health support: A mixed-method meta-analysis.
1. **Im, G.**, & Kim, D. (under review). Korean school counselors' counseling competencies and advocacy activities for LGBTQ+ youth: A latent profile analysis.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

2. **Im, G.**, Jun, E., Yoon, H., & Case, A. S. (in preparation). LGBTQ+ educators in South Korea: A photovoice study on marginalization, resilience, and advocacy.
1. Bae, I., & **Im, G.** (in preparation). Relationship between decent education and decent work for youth: Mediating effects of work volition and career adaptability.

RESEARCH GRANTS

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| 2. | Lee Chang Kook Fund: Queer Research Grant
Beyond the Rainbow Foundation
LGBTQ+ educators in South Korea: A photovoice study
Principal Investigator
\$1,200 | Aug 2025 – Aug 2026 |
| 1. | Mary Bywater Cross and Robert P. Newman Research Award
College of Education, University of Iowa
The relationship between perceived threat of COVID-19, internalized stigma, and depression among LGB individuals: Moderated mediating role of community connectedness
Principal Investigator
\$1,000 | Oct 2024 – May 2025 |

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

13. **Im, G.**, Case, A. S., Bae, I., Ji, S., Tang, Y., & Zhang, Y. (2026, August 6–8). *User engagement with ChatGPT for mental health support: A mixed-method meta-analysis* [Poster presentation]. Division 17 Student Poster Session, APA 2026 Annual Convention, Washington, DC, United States.
12. Zoet, Z., **Im, G.**, Lazo-Salmeron, W., Karimzadeh, L., Park, E., Jensen, S., Clarke, W. F., Perez, J., & Campos, D. (2026, August 6–8). *Critical reflections & action: Moving values from theory to practice* [Invited address]. APA 2026 Annual Convention, Washington, DC, United States.
11. **Im, G.** (2026, August 6–8). *Ethical risk prevention in client generative AI use: Applying the primary risk-management model* [Poster presentation]. APA 2026 Convention, Washington, DC, United States.
10. Zhang, Y., Ben, L., **Im, G.**, & Tang, Y. (2026, February 26–28). *How counselors navigate religious/spiritual value conflict in counseling: A scoping review* [Poster presentation]. SPSP 2026 Annual Convention, Chicago, IL, United States.
9. Kim, J., Kang, S., **Im, G.**, & Kim, M. (2025, August 7–9). *A decade later: Revisiting LGBTQ+ partner loss and bereavement in the post-same-sex marriage era* [Poster presentation]. APA 2025 Convention, Denver, CO, United States.
8. Tang, Y., **Im, G.**, & Zhang, Y. (2025, August 7–9). *Community efforts in promoting youth resilience: A systematic review of community-based intervention* [Poster presentation]. APA 2025 Convention, Denver, CO, United States.
7. Kim, J., Kang, S., **Im, G.**, & Kim, M. (2025, July 11). *A decade later: Revisiting LGBTQ+ partner loss and bereavement in the post-same-sex marriage era* [Paper presentation]. 2025 Korean Association for LGBTQ+ and Queer Studies, Seoul, South Korea.
6. Ko, J., Park, J., **Im, G.**, Cheung, S., & Reid-Marks, L. (2024, August 8–10). *Social stigma, social status, work volition, social support, and positive identity in LGB college students in Korea* [Poster presentation]. APA 2024 Convention, Seattle, WA, United States.
5. Koch, J. M., Shin, Y.-J., Lee, J., & **Im, G.** (2024, July 21–26). *Affirmative psychological practice in LGBTQ-neutral countries* [Poster presentation]. The 33rd International Congress of Psychology, Prague, Czech Republic.
4. Bae, I., & **Im, G.** (2024, June 5). *Relationships between decent education and decent work for youth: Mediating effects of work volition and career adaptability* [Paper presentation]. 2024 Employment Survey Conference, Seoul, South Korea.
3. **Im, G.** (2024, July 19). *Relationships between perceived threat of COVID-19, internalized stigma, and depression among LGB people: Focusing on the moderating effects of community connectedness* [Paper presentation]. The 1st Conference of Junior Scholars Network of LGBTIQ Research, Seoul, South Korea.
2. **Im, G.** (2023, October 11–13). *Overcoming the limitations of school-based suicide post interventions: Focusing on the experiences of key staff members of “Wee Center”* [Poster presentation]. The 23rd International Conference of Educational Research, Seoul, South Korea.
1. Yoon-Lee, S., & **Im, G.** (2023, October 1–31). *“Are we on the same page?”: The critical autoethnography of Korean queer counselors* [Paper presentation]. Society for Sexual, Affectional, Intersex, and Gender Expressive Identities (SAIGE) 2023 Virtual Conference.

SCHOLARSHIPS, FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS, AND HONORS

Graduate Tuition Scholarship College of Education, University of Iowa	2025
Audrey Qualls Travel Award College of Education, University of Iowa	2025
Office of the Dean Graduate Student Travel Award College of Education, University of Iowa	2025

Distinguished Student Research Award Korea Employment Information Service	2024
Semester High Honors College of Education, Seoul National University - 4.3/4.3 GPA, tuition waiver	2023
Brain Korea 21 (BK-21) Plus Scholarship Seoul National University	2022, 2023
Superintendent's Citation of Merit Seoul Metropolitan Superintendent of Education	2021
Scholarship for CAU Alumni Association Chung-Ang University Alumni Association	2017
Semester High Honors College of Education, Chung-Ang University - 4.5/4.5 GPA, tuition waiver	2017
Mentorship Grant Korea Foundation for the Advancement of Science and Creativity (KOFAC)	2016
National Scholarship Korea Student Aid Foundation	2012 – 2017

LEADERSHIP, SERVICE, AND RELATED EXPERIENCE

ADVOCACY & ACTIVISM

Operational Board The EE-MM: Network for Queer and Transgender Counselors in Korea	Jul 2022 – Present
Junior Ombudsperson SNU Human Rights Center, Seoul National University	May 2022 – Aug 2022
Certified Teacher Member LGBTQ Youth Crisis Support Center “Ddingdong”, Seoul, South Korea	Feb 2020 – Present
Chairperson QUV: Solidarity of University Queer Societies in Korea	Sep 2015 – Feb 2016
President LGBTQ+ Student Club “Rainbow Fish”, Chung-Ang University, Seoul, South Korea	Mar 2015 – Feb 2016

LEADERSHIP & PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

International Committee Co-Chair Student Affiliates of Seventeen (SAS) Executive Board, APA Division 17 - Lead the International Committee in developing initiatives that support the professional development of international counseling psychology students - Collaborate with the Executive Board to integrate international perspectives into SAS programming and advocacy efforts	Aug 2025 – Present
Advisory Counselor National Human Rights Commission of the Republic of Korea	May 2019 – Feb 2021
Editorial Committee Task Force for School Counseling System (<i>Wee Project</i>), Korea Educational Development Institute (KEDI)	May 2020 – Nov 2020

EDITORIAL SERVICE

Ad Hoc Reviewer

Translational Issues in Psychological Science	2026 – Present
Psychology of Sexual Orientation and Gender Diversity	2026 – Present
Current Psychology	2026 – Present

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Program Facilitator

Global Youth Summit, The National Council of Youth Organizations in Korea	Jun 2023 – Jul 2023
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Instructor

Every Underachieving Student Succeeds Program, Seoul National University	May 2022 – Jul 2022
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Instructor

Korea Foundation for the Advancement of Science and Creativity (KOFAC)	Jul 2016 – Dec 2016
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Teaching Staff

Pyeongtaek Regional Support Center for Children, Gyeonggi-do, South Korea	Jul 2013 – Aug 2014
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EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Student Reporter

Editorial Team, Daehaknaeil, South Korea	Jul 2015 – Dec 2015
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MILITARY SERVICE

Legal Assistant

Legal Office, Air Force Operations Command, Gyeonggi-do, South Korea	Aug 2012 – Aug 2014
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SKILLS

Language: Korean (native), English (fluent), Japanese (working proficiency)

Statistical Programs: SPSS (PROCESS macro), AMOS, *Mplus*, R, jamovi and STATA

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Counselor , Korean Psychological Association (KPA)	2023
Survey Analyst , Human Resources Development Service of Korea	2021
Certified School Counselor , Korean Ministry of Education (<i>National Teacher Certification</i>)	2018
Certified Secondary English Teacher , Korean Ministry of Education	2018

PROFESSIONAL/COMMUNITY AFFILIATIONS

American Psychological Association

Division 17, Society of Counseling Psychology

Student Affiliates of Seventeen (SAS) Executive Board

Division 44, Society for the Psychology of Sexual Orientation and Gender Diversity

Korean Psychological Association (KPA)

Division 2, Korean Counseling Psychology Association (KCPA)

Korean Counseling Association (KCA)

KCA-International Chapter

Korean Association for LGBTQ+ and Queer Studies
Korean Psychology Network
LGBTQ Youth Crisis Support Center “Ddingdong”
The EE-MM: Network for Queer and Transgender Counselors in Korea

REFERENCES

Amanda S. Case, Ph.D.
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Dennis (Martin) Kivlighan III, Ph.D.
Professor, Department of Psychological and Quantitative Foundations, University of Iowa
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Julie M. Koch, Ph.D.
Professor, Department of Psychological and Quantitative Foundations, University of Iowa
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